

Ros Clayton

Education researcher
PhD Candidate in Economics, Stellenbosch University
rclayton@sun.ac.za

Areas of expertise

Economics of Education; Development Economics; Program Evaluation

Education

PhD in Economics, Stellenbosch University	Expected 2027
Thesis: The Consequences of Grade Repetition in South Africa: Evidence from Early Grades to Secondary School	
Supervisors: Dr Gabrielle Wills and Prof. Servaas van der Berg	
MPhil Education, University of Cambridge	2015
Awarded with distinction.	
Postgraduate Certificate in Education (Mathematics and Economics), University of Cape Town	2012
Awarded with distinction.	
BSocSci (Hons) Economics, University of Cape Town	2011
Awarded in the first class.	
BSocSci Economics and Mathematics, University of Cape Town	2007–2010
Awarded with distinction.	

Experience

Researcher, Resep, Stellenbosch University	2024–present
- Designed and implemented causal inference studies. - Analysed and cleaned large administrative datasets in R (data.table) and Stata. - Conducted quantile regression and fixed effects models to study educational outcomes.	
Researcher, Independent consultant	2023–2024
- Designed and implemented evaluation studies, including an RCT follow-up using administrative datasets. - Leveraged LLMs to code qualitative data.	
Educational Technologist: Learning and Analytics, Siyavula Education	2017–2023
- Ran a significant evaluation of the learning product by matching users on the platform to school administrative data. - Designed and implemented A/B tests to assess new releases.	
Director of Learning, Numeric	2016–2017
- Designed and taught supplementary coursework for pre-service teachers. - Conducted in-classroom observations, typically in poorly-resourced schools.	
Mathematics Teacher (Grades 8–12), Pinelands High School	2012–2014

Selected research and evaluation outputs

- The impact of early grade repetition on test scores** (Resep working paper, 2025.)
- Foundation Phase mastery in home language as a predictor of grade 4 repetition and EFAL marks** (Resep working paper, 2025.)
- SEF Participant Pathways** (Evaluation report for The Learning Trust, 2024; co-authored with Katie Huston.)
- From Grade 7 arithmetic to matric: A quantitative evaluation of the Numeric afterschool maths program** (Evaluation report for Numeric, 2024.)
- Growing apart: Tracking the pro-girl achievement gap across early grades in South African primary schools** (Manuscript under revision for journal submission, 2026; co-authored with Dr Gabrielle Wills.)

Presentations

- **The effect of early-grade repetition on Home Language performance** (The Reading Panel, 2026.)
- **The impact of early grade repetition on test scores** (Economic Society of South Africa Centenary Conference, 2025.)
- **Foundation Phase mastery in home language as a predictor of grade 4 repetition and EFAL marks** (RESEP Quantitative Education Conference, University of Stellenbosch, 2025.)

Policy and public-facing writing

- **The impact of early grade repetition on learner marks** (Resep policy brief, 2025.)
- **How home language mastery predicts early learning outcomes** (Resep policy brief, 2025.)

Research impact and media

- Interviewed by SABC News on gender gaps in South African schooling and the Grade 4 linguistic transition.
- Interviewed by Newzroom Afrika on how early grade repetition affects learning outcomes.

Technical skills

R, Stata, Python, LaTeX, GitHub